P1: Probabilistic electricity-price forecasting under regime shift

Reference implementation v1.1.0

SIMULATED BENCHMARK - NOT FIELD DATA. This report concerns a research-training portfolio, not a named electricity market, employer, Tarim Oilfield or trading system. The reference experiments compare established forecasting and calibration methods on simulated data. Configurations, inputs and execution metadata accompany the saved results; VERIFICATION.md explains the current checks.

Purpose and experimental design

The question is how raw quantile forecasts, static conformal calibration and a rolling adaptive wrapper trade coverage against interval width when a simulated electricity-price process changes regime. This is an implementation and evaluation exercise using established methods; no new foundational algorithm is proposed.

The simulator produces 420 hourly days from 1 January 2024, with stable, volatile and renewable-shift regimes. Its 10,080 rows yield 9,888 direct forecast examples after eight days of history. Chronological issue-day splits contain 247 training, 82 calibration and 83 final-evaluation days. The final 1,992 targets span 3 December 2024-23 February 2025 and all belong to the renewable-shift regime. The final block is reused for gamma sensitivities and is not an untouched test set after that exploration.

Seven pooled histogram-gradient-boosting models estimate quantiles .05, .10, .25, .50, .75, .90 and .95, using horizon as a feature. Each has 140 iterations; row-wise sorting repairs quantile crossings. Features combine calendar variables, past price summaries and simulated forecast proxies. Future realised covariates and regime labels are excluded from model features. Static CQR uses either pooled calibration scores or separate horizon scores. The adaptive wrapper retains 30 scores per horizon, target miscoverage .20 and reference gamma .015.

Main baseline: seed 20260817

Method	Coverage	Mean width	Interval score
Raw quantiles	.556225	11.896091	34.007247
Static CQR, pooled	.924197	27.580914	32.176642
Static CQR, by horizon	.923695	28.378878	33.032735
Adaptive CQR	.806225	21.274739	30.727504

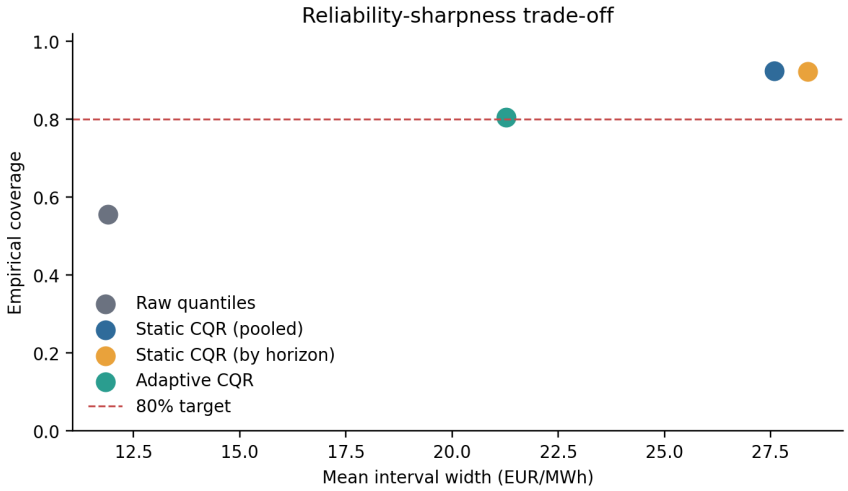
Width is in EUR/MWh. Lower interval score is better. The median model MAE is 6.299118 versus 11.268044 for the seasonal-naive forecast; mean pinball loss is 2.016259. The reported approximate CRPS, 4.501505, integrates only the available .05-.95 quantile grid and omits the tails; it is not exact full-distribution CRPS. All methods share the same raw quantiles, so these point/quantile metrics cannot distinguish interval wrappers. This sample does not establish general superiority.

Finite-sample conformal rank: implementation details

For calibration score s_i = max(lower_i - y_i, y_i - upper_i) and n finite scores, set k = ceil((n+1)*(1-alpha)). For 1 <= k <= n, the correction is sorted score s_(k), indexed k-1 in code. If k > n, the augmented conformal score is positive infinity and the interval becomes unbounded. Alpha must be finite and strictly between zero and one. Empty, non-vector or nonfinite scores are rejected.

Passing k/n to np.quantile(..., method='higher') is not equivalent to selecting s_(k): NumPy maps that probability using n-1 positions. For scores 0-19, alpha .20 gives k=17: the required value is 16, whereas that quantile call returns 17. Capping k>n at the largest finite score would also lose the augmented infinity. Decimal alpha text is used for rank arithmetic to avoid .7 at n=9 becoming the wrong integer through binary roundoff; adjacent representable alpha values are tested separately.

The score convention is based on established conformalized quantile regression. Its standard finite-sample coverage justification requires the relevant exchangeability conditions. Changing the rank does not make those conditions hold in this dependent, shifted simulator. The current rank selection and unattainable-rank behavior are covered by regression tests.



Corrected baseline coverage versus unconditional mean width.

Gamma sensitivity and seed robustness

The reference gamma remains .015. The .030 and .050 runs are exploratory sensitivities using the same seed, raw model and final block. They are not an independent basis for selecting a universally optimal adaptation rate.

Gamma	Adaptive coverage	Mean width	Interval score
.015	.806225	21.274739	30.727504
.030	.798193	21.107557	30.833048
.050	.795181	20.784492	30.999364

Here larger gamma slightly narrows intervals and reduces coverage; the interval score worsens. This result is more cautious than a claim that faster adaptation necessarily improves reliability. Static and raw metrics are unchanged across these gamma runs, as expected.

Two additional simulation seeds use the entire unchanged baseline configuration, including 420 days, seven quantile models, gamma .015 and all three rolling folds. Together with the reference they give three baseline market simulations.

Seed	Raw coverage	Adaptive coverage	Adaptive width	Adaptive score
20260817	.556225	.806225	21.274739	30.727504
20260818	.539157	.814257	22.176603	32.236669
20260819	.558735	.817269	22.474140	32.780810

Adaptive coverage ranges .806225-.817269 across these three seeds. These runs are a limited simulator check, not a confidence interval for real-market coverage. Changing the seed also changes the model's random seed; this experiment does not separate model stochasticity from simulated-market variation.

Fixed-alpha rolling-window control

The static by-horizon method fixes a correction using all 82 calibration days; the adaptive wrapper both rolls a 30-score buffer and updates alpha. A gamma=0 control retains the identical rolling buffers, raw quantiles and alpha target .20, isolating feedback from the rolling-window effect. Each of the three baseline models was reconstructed once, and its test raw quantiles and adaptive bounds matched the preserved reference exactly before comparison.

Seed	Fixed coverage	Fixed width	Fixed score	Adaptive score
20260817	.820281	21.768209	30.592811	30.727504
20260818	.822289	22.472269	32.070489	32.236669
20260819	.825803	22.681780	32.514927	32.780810

Feedback narrows widths by .208-.493 EUR/MWh and moves coverage nearer .80, but worsens interval score in all three seeds by .135-.266. These data do not establish an interval-score advantage for alpha feedback alone. The adaptive/static comparison evaluates the combined wrapper. Shared raw frames, interval paths, metrics and execution records are in corrected_v110/supplementary_20261021/. This control reuses the existing final blocks rather than an untouched test set.

Infinity and clipping are part of the method boundary

The update uses alpha_next = clip(alpha + gamma*(.20-error), .01, .99) and a rolling score distribution. It is inspired by Adaptive Conformal Inference, but clipping changes the unmodified recursion. The usual telescoping argument for that recursion cannot be transferred to this wrapper without a new analysis.

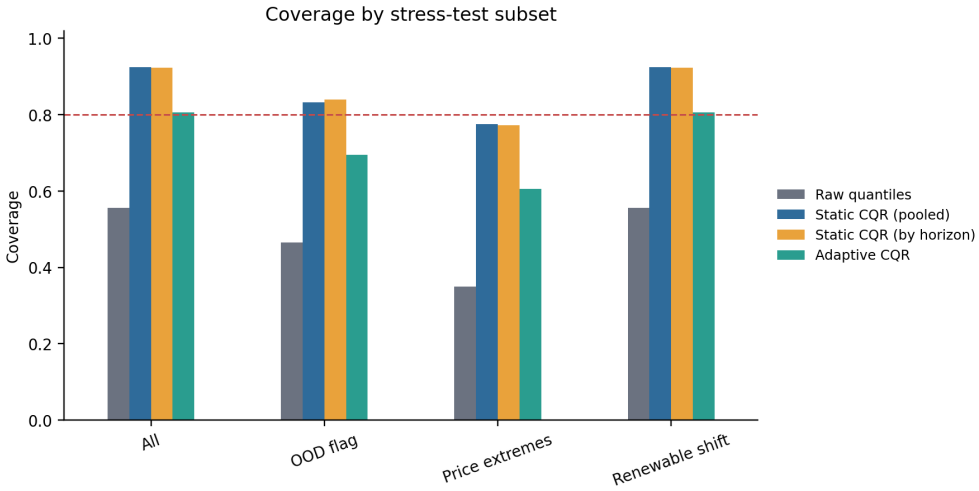
With 30 scores, an alpha below 1/31 requires an infinite conformal bound. The code honors that case, and the test suite verifies propagation into adaptive intervals. In all five completed runs, final-test unbounded fractions are zero. This observation does not justify replacing future infinities with finite caps. If an unbounded interval occurs, unconditional mean width and interval score remain infinite. Explicit finite_only_mean_width and finite_only_interval_score columns describe the finite subset only; they do not replace full-sample metrics.

Stress subsets reveal conditional failures

Overall adaptive coverage close to .80 hides much poorer coverage among extremes and flagged examples. Price extremes are the lower and upper empirical deciles of the final outcomes, selected retrospectively for evaluation. They are not issuance-time labels. The OOD flag uses a training-standardised feature-distance score and a training 95th-percentile threshold; it is a simple diagnostic, not a validated detector of operational failure.

Subset	Rows	Raw coverage	Pooled coverage	Adaptive coverage
All	1,992	.556225	.924197	.806225
Price extremes	400	.350000	.775000	.605000
OOD flag	131	.465649	.832061	.694656

For price extremes, adaptive mean width is 22.455469 and score is 53.229701, compared with pooled width 29.173814 and score 47.900275. Adaptive calibration does not dominate pooled calibration on this subset. OOD adaptive width is 22.096972 and score 38.840207. These small, dependent subsets do not support precise inferential claims.



Coverage by stress subset. Renewable shift and All refer to the same final rows.

All final-evaluation rows are renewable-shift examples: Renewable shift repeats All. This table contains no volatile-regime rows and cannot establish performance in that regime. The rolling diagnostics below cover earlier periods.

Rolling-origin diagnostic

Each chronological expanding-window fold uses 42 calibration days, followed by 28 evaluation days (672 hours). Folds share one constructed timeline and are not independent replications.

Fold	Evaluation start	Raw coverage	Pooled coverage	Adaptive coverage
1	2024-07-16	.671131	.791667	.805060
2	2024-09-02	.486607	.578869	.720238
3	2024-10-20	.395833	.784226	.808036

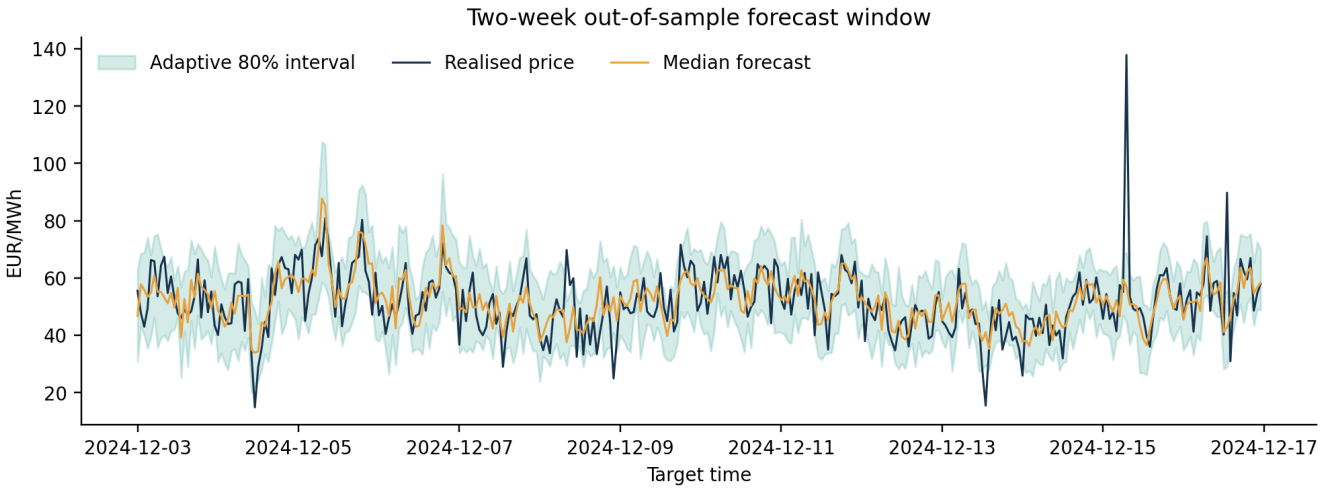
Fold 2 adaptive coverage is only .720238. Reporting the final .806225 alone would therefore hide a material reliability failure under a different segment of shift.

Timing and joint uncertainty limitations

Daily issue time is midnight and target horizon 1 is that same midnight. Thus horizon 1 is nowcast-like and the other targets have lead times 1-23 hours. A claim of operational 24-hour day-ahead forecasting requires an adapter with a genuine prior issuance cutoff.

Price lags and summary features use past history. Forward fill uses observations available before issuance; incomplete leading history is rejected rather than backfilled from future values. Nonetheless, the load, renewable and temperature forecast proxies are constructed from simulated realised series with added noise. They are assumed available at issuance and may be more informative than actual forecasts. There are no publication-vintage or revision records to prove real availability. This distinction must carry into any downstream scheduling study.

Adaptive buffers are separate by horizon. An earlier horizon's outcome on the same issue day does not update a later horizon's buffer. A horizon uses earlier days' outcomes before its next prediction, assuming immediate publication once the target is observed. Delays, settlement revisions and data outages require an explicit operational availability model before deployment.



First two weeks of corrected evaluation forecasts, with marginal adaptive intervals.

An 80% hourly marginal interval does not imply an 80% chance that all 24 hourly prices lie inside their intervals. These models do not calibrate a daily maximum score, a simultaneous band, a temporal copula or joint scenario distribution. Passing these marginal quantiles or widths into downstream optimisation does not establish joint price-path calibration, guarantee a dispatch risk level, or prove that a chosen CVaR objective is calibrated to realised losses.

Row-wise sorting also alters the original fitted quantile functions. Only seven quantile levels are available; tail shape between and beyond them is not learned by this report. The simple OOD score ignores temporal structure and feature correlations. These are concrete directions for validation, not claims of solved operational risk management.

Reproducibility and verification

Version metadata and runtime version are both 1.1.0. The reference environment uses Windows Python 3.13.15, NumPy 2.3.5, pandas 2.2.3, SciPy 1.17.0 and scikit-learn 1.8.0. Configurations, software versions and data fingerprints are recorded with each run; requirements-lock.txt gives the reference dependencies.

The current verification consists of 35 unit and pipeline tests, checks of all five saved reference runs, and replay of all three fixed/adaptive rolling-control comparisons. The suite covers exact conformal ranks, alpha boundaries, ties, invalid inputs, infinity propagation, conditional diagnostics, configured quantile/coverage targets, plot ranges and protected output paths. Temporal tests check chronological separation, forbidden future features, leading missing history, horizon separation, and independence from an interval's own outcome. Small real-model pipeline tests exercise the complete path without fitting the full 420-day reference models.

The saved-output checker recalculates timing and interval metrics; the control checker replays both rolling wrappers from saved raw forecasts. Neither checker retrains a model or changes the reference files. The GitHub workflow runs on Ubuntu and Windows with Python 3.11 and 3.13; its results are in this repository's Actions tab. These are checks of specific invariants and saved results, not a proof against every defect or of real-market validity.

Five full corrected experiment runs are saved under corrected_v110/: baseline, gamma .030, gamma .050, and additional baseline seeds 20260818/20260819. Each has a manifest, four tables, six figures, simulated data and forecast exports. Reference execution logs are in corrected_v110/logs/. Run and study manifests retain the actual execution dates, software versions, source hashes and input fingerprints. Current check results and output are in verification/. The separate PUBLICATION_MANIFEST.json lists the distributed files and their hashes.

The baseline CSV has 1,992 rows and includes raw quantiles, pooled/horizon static bounds, adaptive bounds, alpha, correction and OOD columns. To run the tests, saved-result checks or a new experiment, follow the commands in README.md. VERIFICATION.md describes the checks in more detail. Method references are in RELATED_WORK.md.

Overall adaptive coverage is near .80 in the evaluated final blocks, while stress subsets and one rolling fold fail. Three simulated seeds do not establish real-market external validity, arbitrary time-series coverage, or jointly reliable daily paths. A next study would need real publication vintages, a true issuance gap, delayed-label handling, additional untouched temporal blocks and an explicitly validated joint uncertainty model.

Relevant verified primary references

Romano, Y., Patterson, E., and Candès, E. J. (2019). Conformalized Quantile Regression. Source of the quantile-based conformity score and static CQR framework.

Gibbs, I., and Candès, E. (2021). Adaptive Conformal Inference Under Distribution Shift. Source motivating the adaptive update; its guarantees are not asserted for this clipped, rolling implementation.